

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Legal Assistant role at Essential Employment because childcare proceedings sit at the point where legal procedure and real vulnerability intersect most directly, and my background preparing hearing materials, managing case files under pressure, and communicating with clients in sensitive situations is directly transferable to supporting a busy local authority team.

At BCLP, I spent six months in the Real Estate Disputes team preparing electronic hearing bundles, assisting with court materials and skeleton arguments, and tracking deadlines across several competing matters. Shortly before a significant arbitration deadline in the International Arbitration team, I became the only junior supporting the matter and took responsibility for coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions to ensure on-time submission. That experience showed me what it takes to keep proceedings on track when the pressure is high, and the document management and deadline discipline I developed there translates directly to updating court bundles in line with directions and managing the volume of paperwork childcare proceedings generate.

At Citizens Advice, I work with clients across housing, welfare and family matters, many of whom are in genuinely difficult circumstances. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence, and translate procedural requirements into practical guidance for people who are often unfamiliar with legal processes. Drafting accurately, redacting sensitive material carefully, and communicating clearly with vulnerable individuals are all things I do regularly. That day-to-day exposure to client-facing work in a pressured, high-volume environment is good preparation for supporting childcare lawyers who need reliable, careful assistance with both documentation and client liaison.

Local authority childcare work is an area where procedural precision matters because the consequences of errors are serious. I want to work in an environment where that precision is genuinely important, and where the legal work has a direct public protection purpose. This role, supporting senior lawyers and the Head of Team across the full range of childcare proceedings, is the kind of hands-on paralegal experience I am looking to build on as I develop toward qualification.

I am available immediately and happy to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva